

Russell Dudek

CONSULTING AI DIRECTOR | AI ACTIVATION, OPERATING MODELS & VALUE REALIZATION

Pittsburgh, PA | 412.287.8640 | russelldudek@gmail.com | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/russelldudek> | <https://russelldudek.github.io/BakerTillyUS/>

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Operator-technologist with 20+ years connecting complex technology, operating priorities, cross-functional teams, and measurable execution. Builds the mechanisms that move AI from possibility to adopted work: opportunity framing, workflow redesign, business cases, technical requests, governance, human review, evaluation, enablement, and portfolio discipline.

SELECTED LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Vape-Jet

Director of Operations | 2025-Present

- Leads AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connects factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Operates in a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision environment with approximately 1,000 fielded robots informing support and operating feedback loops.

DudeWorth

Founder / AI and Automation Advisor | 2017-Present

- Develops AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks assessing value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Designs agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Advises on AI-enabled operations, logistics technology, automation, network analysis, and workflow design.

Amazon

Operations Management / Site Leader | 2014-2018

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and operating mechanisms across safety, quality, speed, customer experience, and engagement.
- Served on the Amazon Prime Now launch team with Whole Foods and contributed to logistics innovation through Prime Air research and Amazon Flex geolocation concepts.

ROLE-ALIGNED STRENGTHS

Consulting AI vision and activation

AI-enabled workflow redesign

Business-to-technology translation

Portfolio prioritization and business cases

Generative AI, RAG, agents and evaluation

Human-in-the-loop and responsible AI

Adoption, learning and change mechanisms

Operating scorecards and executive cadence

SELECTED PROOF

~1,000 fielded robots in the operating feedback environment

~5M annual second-day orders supported in Amazon Prime Pittsburgh environment

\$200M social impact bond feasibility concept helped shape and evaluate

APPLIED TOOLKIT

Agentic AI · LLM workflows · RAG patterns · Human-in-the-loop design · Python · SQL · JavaScript · TensorFlow · Tableau · Odoo · Jira · Confluence · HubSpot · Slack

SELECTED OPERATING MECHANISMS

Portfolio discipline

Frame value, feasibility, readiness, governance, adoption, reuse, and time-to-value.

Capability requests

Specify workflow context, data, integrations, authority, controls, evaluation, and outcomes.

Adoption system

Connect role expectations, training, local ownership, scorecards, and operating cadence.

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ADDITIONAL LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Compunetics

Director of Operations and Engineering Management | 2000-2013

- Progressed through R&D program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Built quality systems, standard work, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls; collaborated with DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD.
- Published industry articles, delivered technical talks, and participated in the HyperTransport Consortium.

Cardinal Building Products

Regional Director | 2021-2023

- Built the company's first remote regional operation and modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital-marketing, and online-buying workflows.
- Advanced AI-enhanced transportation-management and route-planning concepts.

ZeusVu

Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations | 2018-2022

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and computer-vision-enabled field intelligence; designed medical delivery and chain-of-custody concepts.

Enviro Social Capital

Chairman of the Board | 2014-2017

Co-founded and led a public-private impact initiative; helped shape and evaluate a \$200 million Social Impact Bond feasibility concept for Pittsburgh green-infrastructure improvement.

IEEE

CMPT and EDS Pittsburgh Chapter Chair | 2012-2016

Led regional technology programming connecting industry, academia, STEM outreach, electronics, manufacturing, and emerging technology.

REPRESENTATIVE APPLIED WORK

AI readiness and activation

Business-value framing, readiness scoring, milestone roadmaps, and role-based work systems.

Agentic workflow design

Structured context, retrieval, human authority, exception handling, evaluation, and governance patterns.

Connected operations

ERP, CRM, work management, collaboration, telemetry, dashboards, standard work, and escalation.

Autonomous-system concepts

Computer vision, aerial inventory, geolocation, medical delivery, and chain-of-custody concepts.

EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh

Bachelor of Science
Academic grounding in materials science and physical chemistry.

SELECTED CREDENTIALS

Google AI Essentials

IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner

Six Sigma Certification

OSHA 10

LEADERSHIP SIGNATURE

Makes complex work visible, challenges unsupported assumptions, establishes decision rights, and connects strategy to operating cadence.

TARGET CONTRIBUTION

Own the Consulting AI vision, activation agenda, prioritization, business requirements, and value-realization system while serving as a technically credible counterpart to enterprise platform teams.